

Nomura's leading index of Asian exports

NELI continues its rise to loftier levels, signaling an Asian export supercycle.

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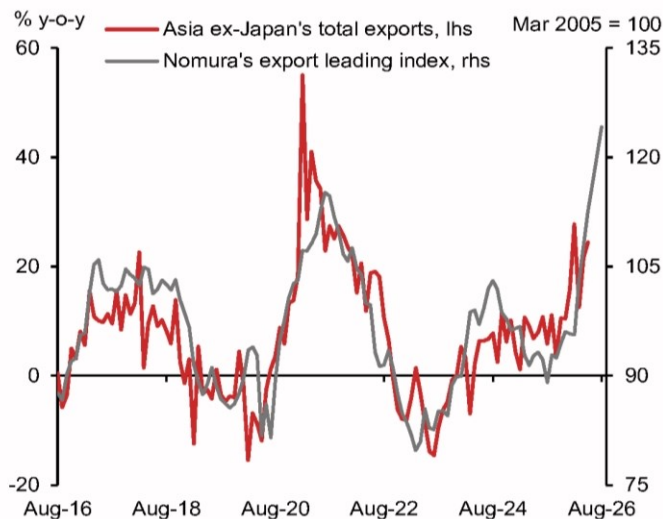
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Fig. 1: Nomura's leading index of Asian exports



- Nomura's leading index of Asia ex-Japan's aggregate exports, or NELI for short, comprises nine components and has a three-month lead time. NELI has correctly predicted past major turning points and is less distorted by base effects than official export data, making it a good momentum leading indicator of Asia's underlying export growth.
- NELI extended its rising streak, surging to 124.2 in August. This suggests Asia's export growth momentum is showing no signs of slowing into Q3. The rise is underpinned by continued strength in tech-related indicators and rising Chinese import demand.
- The AI tech supercycle remains the principal driver of Asian export growth and there are *signs of it broadening out*. However, with the re-escalation of the US-Iran conflict, the renewed blockage of the SoH and the Houthis threatening disruptions to cargo shipments through the Red Sea, global supply chain pressures may start to re-emerge. As a result, downside risks to Asian exports may begin to materialise.

Note: Nomura's export leading index can be found on Bloomberg (see ticker: NMEIXLI). Asia ex-Japan's aggregate (nominal) exports include those of China, Hong Kong, India, Indonesia, South Korea, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore, Taiwan and Thailand. China's exports to Hong Kong are excluded due to outsized swings on some occasions that seem unrelated to trade activity. Nomura's export leading index is a weighted (inverse of mean-squared errors) sum of the following Z-score standardized variables: Shanghai Shipping Exchange Containerized Freight Index, China's imports, China's imports from Asia, global semiconductor sales, US manufacturing ISM, S&P EM manufacturing PMI, China RatingDog (formerly Caixin) manufacturing PMI, South Korea's semiconductor exports and Philadelphia Semiconductor index. (For more details on its construction, see *Re-calibrating our Asia export leading index*, 16 August 2022).

Source: IHS Markit, CEIC, Bloomberg and Nomura Global Economics.

Appendix A-1

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